



THE **REAL TIMES**

Real News in Real Time



CELEBRATING
30 YEARS of
FOML IN ZAMBIA

No: 0908

Friday, August 21, 2026

f Real Times Digital Newspaper

+260 974 372 181

‘Count me out’

...Tonse Alliance SG distances himself from any move to challenge presidential poll results

(Page 2)

Teacher’s promotions for sale?

By Linda Nyondo

The Zambia Congress of Trade Unions (ZCTU) has alleged that some teachers are paying inducements of K20,000 to secure promotions.

ZCTU president Blake Mulala said today that teachers had taken out loans to pay what he described as corrupt senior officers who upgraded them from their current grades to higher ones.

“We must not allow this kind of irregularity to continue. Upgrading a civil servant must be transparent and must be carried out in accordance with labour laws,” he said.

Meanwhile, the trade union has praised President Hakainde Hichilema for creating jobs in the civil service, and urged people who were asked to record names of beneficiaries at campaign rallies not to substitute relatives for those who were actually present.

Mr Mulala also congratulated the governing United Party for National Development (UPND) and urged newly elected members of parliament to represent their electorates prudently.

“Politicians must be accountable and tolerant of each other,” he said, adding that leaders should demonstrate peace, unity and professionalism. He called on people to avoid abusing power and to uphold and respect human rights.

Mr Mulala also expressed concern about the spread of rumours and inflammatory statements on social media, saying they could lead to anarchy.

He called for the establishment of a police directorate to curb perpetrators of violence who use online platforms, and urged that content creators who spread hatred be arrested.

“There is no need to attack each other or to express disappointment at the way a certain group voted it is their democratic right,” he said. “Zambia is a democratic country and in a democracy it is the people who win.”

The ZCTU president appealed to losing candidates to accept the outcome of elections and warned against insulting the Electoral Commission of Zambia, security agencies and the judiciary.

He also called for an end to the spread of misinformation and propaganda.

He commended the government for not shutting down the internet during the election period, saying the decision demonstrated a commitment to transparency and accountability. Mr Mulala described the election period as largely peaceful, but said one ZCTU member who served as poll staff was killed in Matero.



Dr Chris Zumani

Patrick Mwansa alive - ZP

By Ruth Kambita

Police have denied online claims that Patrick Mwansa, husband to former late president’s daughter Tasila Lungu has died while in police custody.

In a statement released today by Deputy Police Public Relations Officer Chipo Kaitisha, Police has described the reports as “false and mislead-

ing”

Ms Kaitisha confirmed that Mr Mwansa is alive and in good health and that his family has been permitted to visit him in accordance with established procedures.

She has criticised the circulation of unverified information on social media and called on the public, bloggers and social-media users to refrain from sharing material that could cause unnecessary

panic and distress to the family and the wider community.

“The public is encouraged to rely on official communications from the Zambia Police Service for accurate and verified updates,” she said.

The Police has also reaffirmed its commitment to upholding the rights, dignity, safety and welfare of all persons in custody, in line with the law and established procedures.

Meanwhile, three artists, including musicians Moses Ng’andwe (popularly Chester MoPower), Felix Mangani Phiri (Felix Ndangeni Inshila) and comedian Winston Ngosa (IDC Light Comedy), together with 14 others, have been charged with riotous behaviour and possession of offensive weapons.

Western Province Police Commanding Officer Godfrey Mwanza said the dockets have

been submitted to the National Prosecution Authority (NPA) for perusal, and a court date will be set after prosecutorial processes are complete.

The suspects remain in custody at Mongu Correctional Facility following their arrest on August 5, 2026.

Mr Mwanza said a specific appearance date has not yet been confirmed. Their lawyer, Wisdom Nyirenda, had earlier indicated the group was

expected to appear in court yesterday, but no appearance took place.

The arrests have prompted strong reactions on social media, where fellow artists and members of the public have called for their release. “Free Chester! Free IDC! Free uncle Felix!” posted one user, while another wrote, “We all have the right to make choices. Free our people please.”

Real News in Real Time

“Let peace reign”

By Alex Maboshe

Civil society organisations have called for peace, restraint and national healing following Zambia’s 2026 General Election, urging political actors and citizens to reject violence and resolve grievances through

lawful means.

The appeal follows reports of violence, abductions and the death of former Lunte MP Mutotwe Kafwaya during the election period.

In a joint statement, the groups said such incidents have no place in Zambia’s

democracy and must never be normalised.

Signatories include the Advocates for Democratic Governance Foundation, ActionAid Zambia, Alliance for Community Action, LCK Freedom Foundation, Caritas Zambia, Chapter One Foundation, Jesuit Centre for Theological Reflection, PANOS Zambia, Transparency International Zambia, NGOCC and Free Press Initiative.

They urged political actors and supporters to exercise maximum restraint and pursue complaints only through constitutional channels, including the courts.

The public was also called on to remain calm and resist any incitement to violence.

The organisations stressed the need to rebuild confidence in democratic institutions and protect Zambia’s tradition of peaceful elections, placing the right to life and human dignity at the centre of the response.

They demanded an independent and transparent investigation into Kafwaya’s death during a reported security operation, and called on the government, security agencies, political parties and other stakeholders to ensure truth, justice and the rule of law prevail.

LPG market faces pricing pressure

By Luyando Mukuka

Energy expert Luka Bwalya says rising supplier prices and stiff competition are creating challenges for businesses operating in Zambia’s Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG) market.

Mr. Bwalya says LPG distributors have limited control over the prices they pay for the product because suppliers determine the cost at which gas is delivered to them.

He says distributors are often left with little choice but to accept the prices offered by suppliers, particularly after committing themselves to selling LPG to customers.

Mr. Bwalya says international developments are also contributing to price fluctuations, citing geopolitical tensions, including

the conflict involving Iran and the United States, as factors that have affected energy markets.

He says distributors are further facing pressure from competitors who reduce prices in an effort to attract more customers.

According to Mr. Bwalya, such price competition can force other distributors to lower their prices despite having purchased LPG at higher costs, potentially squeezing their profit margins.

He says the combination of volatile supply prices and competition remains a major challenge for LPG distributors and could affect the stability of prices for consumers.

Mr. Bwalya’s comments come amid growing interest in LPG as an alternative energy source, highlighting the need for a more stable and competitive LPG supply market in Zambia.

TZ driver convicted for illegally transporting timber

By Luyando Mukuka

A Tanzanian truck driver has been fined K60,000 by the Isoka Magistrate Court for transporting 26 cubic metres of Mukwa timber without the required CITES Certificate.

Salum Yusuf, 52, was apprehended by Zambia National Service officers at the Isoka ZNS Checkpoint on July 11, 2026, while transporting the timber. The consignment was subsequently handed over to the Forestry Department for investigations.

Yusuf told authorities that he had an export licence and other documents from the Democratic Republic of Congo showing that the timber had been loaded in Lubumbashi and was being transported in transit through Tanzania, with China as its final destination.

However, he could not produce the CITES Certificate required for the international trade of regulated species.

The Department of National Parks and Wildlife, working with the Forestry Department, formally arrested Yusuf on July 23 and charged him under Sections 91 and 99 of the Forest Act, read together with Statutory Instrument No. 79 on Zambia’s implementation

of CITES.

He pleaded guilty before Magistrate Deborah Mubanga on July 27 and was convicted and fined K60,000, which was paid by a third party. He would otherwise have served nine months in prison.

The State subsequently applied for forfeiture of the timber, truck and trailer. However, the court ordered that the timber and vehicle be restored to their rightful owners after finding that the timber had not been unlawfully obtained.

The State has since appealed the decision to the High Court and obtained a stay of execution, temporarily

suspending the restoration order pending determination of the appeal.

Mukwa, scientifically known as *Pterocarpus angolensis*, is a valuable timber species found across southern and eastern Africa and is subject to international trade controls.

In a statement issued to the Real Times, Wildlife Crime Prevention (WCP) Assistant Communications Officer Salima Nvula said the case highlights the importance of strengthened border controls in combating illegal timber trade and protecting forests, biodiversity and legitimate timber businesses.

Headman, wife murdered in Sinazongwe maize field

By Ruth Kambita

Headman Benson Simabula of Simabbula Village in Sinazongwe District and his wife, Mbongole Jane Muzingili, have been murdered by unknown persons in their maize field.

The couple, aged 70 and 65 respectively, had reportedly been spending most of their time in the field, where they planted winter maize in May 2026 and had been staying there to guard the crop from animals.

On August 19, 2026, Mr. Simabula was seen walking around Malyango Village in Sinazongwe District at about 12:00 hours.

The following day, at around 06:00 hours, the victim’s brother received a phone call from one of the couple’s children informing him that their parents had been killed in the maize field.

He rushed to the field,

where he found the bodies and confirmed the report before informing Sinazongwe Police Station.

Southern Province Police Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo said officers who visited the scene found the couple lying on a mattress under a mosquito net inside the maize field.

He said the bodies were facing each other and covered with blankets. Mr. Namalongo said a physical inspection showed that both deceased persons had sustained multiple severe head injuries, adding that a sharp object is suspected to have been used in the attack.

The bodies have been deposited at Maamba General Hospital Mortuary in Sinazongwe District, awaiting postmortem examinations.

No arrests have been made, and investigations are continuing.

‘Count me out’

By Alex Maboshe

Tonse Alliance founder and Secretary General Zumani Zimba has distanced himself from any move to challenge the presidential election results, calling instead for dialogue, national healing and reconciliation following the Tonse Alliance’s defeat.

President Hakainde Hichilema of the United Party for National Development (UPND) secured 2,965,326 votes, representing 61.4 percent of valid votes cast.

Brian Mundubile, who stood as the Tonse Alliance candidate under the National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP), obtained 1,855,217 votes, or 38 percent.

Mr Mundubile has indicated he intends to petition the results through constitutional and judicial channels, citing alleged irregularities, inconsistencies and issues in the conduct, counting, transmission and declaration of the results.

Dr Zimba, however, made clear he would play no part in such a challenge.

“As for me, Tonse Alliance founder, SG and Chief Advi-

sor, I will not be part of it. Let dialogue, healing, peace and reconciliation reign now to serve many detained and hiding,” he said.

Other parties in the alliance have already conceded. Resolute Party (RP) president Martin Phiri described the elections as free and fair, stating that his party would not petition the outcome and would instead rally behind the re-elected president.

NRPUP president Ezra Tembo similarly congratulated President Hichilema, saying the party accepts the results and respects the will of the people.

Mr. Tembo noted that a party barely three months old had performed creditably and reiterated its commitment to serving as the main opposition by providing checks and balances.

In a Facebook post the day after the election, Dr Zimba further called for an inclusive government of national unity.

He urged urgent dialogue between President Hichilema and Mundubile, warning that the contest had become “dangerously divisive” and stressing that the two leaders “are not eternal enemies.”



18 Kitwe rioters nabbed

By Alex Maboshe

Two individuals in Katete are nursing serious gunshot wounds after a Greener rifle discharged accidentally while they climbed Mphangwe Mountain in search of wild animals.

Jackson Phiri, 26, and Kelvin Moyo, 28, were injured around 22:00 hours last night in Chief Kawaza's area.

The pair had left around 19:00 hours after Jackson collected Kelvin from his home and invited him on the hunting trip.

According to Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba, Jackson was carrying the Greener rifle when it suddenly went off as the two men made their way up the mountain.

Jackson sustained a fractured right elbow, while Kelvin was hit by two bullets in his right armpit and one in his left cheek.

Despite their injuries, the friends managed to descend the mountain and sought help from 40-year-old Peter Zimba of Mphangwe Farms.

Zimba then contacted Jackson's father, Duncan Phiri, 52, of Chilingondi Farm Number 35, who reported the incident to Katete Police Station around midnight.

The injured men were issued medical report forms at the police station before being taken to St Francis Mission Hospital, where they remain admitted.

Police said the firearm, whose serial number has not yet been established, belongs to Donald Banda of Chilingondi Farms.

"The firearm is not yet recovered as investigations are ongoing," Mweemba said.



Vice President Dr. W.K. Mutale Nalumango Interacts with Kulima tower Bus Drivers when they called on her at Government House today. Picture by ROYD SIBAJENE/ZANIS

Wynter questions Tonse poll petition

By Alex Maboshe

Former Justice Minister Wynter Kabimba has cast doubt on the Tonse Alliance's decision to petition the results of the August 13 general election, following concerns that the executive could influence the

judiciary to favour the ruling party.

President Hakainde Hichilema was on August 18th re-elected in the recent polls with over 2,057,986 votes beating Opposition leader Brian Mundubile who got 1,190,920 votes.

The Tonse Alliance has since announced its intention to challenge the outcome in court, citing alleged irregularities in the electoral process.

Some alliance supporters have expressed fears of a compromised judicial system, claiming executive interfer-

ence could result in the petition being dismissed.

Speaking in an interview, Mr. Kabimba argued that if the opposition lacks confidence in the judiciary, it should explore alternative channels to raise its grievances.

He stressed that the judi-

ciary is an independent institution whose mandate ought to be respected and trusted.

Separately, Lusaka-based lawyer Isaac Simbeye urged the courts to remain impartial and handle the opposition's concerns strictly in accordance with the law.

Barbra Banda makes WAFCON Morocco ‘26 Best XI



By Benedict Tembo

Copper Queens forward Barbra Banda has made the TotalEnergies CAF Africa Cup of Nations Morocco 2026 Best XI despite only having played three games.

Banda, the only Zambian in the Morocco 2026 Best XI, scored five goals and made one assist for the Copper Queens who suffered early elimination from the tournament.

She scored four goals in the opening Group ‘C’ match against Egypt and a goal in the match against Malawi.

The other countries represented in the Morocco Best XI are eventual winners

Cameroun with four players, Algeria and hosts players Morocco two players apiece.

Malawi’s Chawinga sisters, Temwa and Tabitha were also being named in the 2026 WAFCON Best XI.

The two sisters had a massive tournament, propelling their team, in their debut appearance, to the final of the tournament ultimately losing to Cameroun.

Temwa scored five goals and two assists to win the golden boot while Tabitha scored four goals for the team.

The two scored 75 per-cent of Malawi’s 12 goals at the tournament.

By Benedict Tembo

Zambian gaffer Anderson Phiri has been appointed head coach by struggling Zimbabwean Premier League (ZPL) side Agama Football Club.

In a statement, Agama said they were delighted to unveil Phiri as the club’s new head coach.

“Coach Phiri joins Agama FC with valuable coaching experience gained from his previous engagements, including a coaching stint in Namibia, where he worked in a competitive football environment.

In Namibia, Phiri was in charge of KK Palace FC and Bucks Bucaneers FC.

The former Power Dynamos’ coach takes over at a crucial stage of the season and has been entrusted with the responsibility of steering Agama FC away from the relegation zone and guiding the team to safety,” Agama said in their statement.

His immediate task will be to restore confidence, improve the team’s performances, instil a winning mentality and maximise points from the remaining league fixtures.

“The club believes his experience, technical knowledge, leadership and understanding of the game



will be crucial in turning around the team’s fortunes. Agama FC management, players and supporters warmly welcome coach Anderson Phiri to the Agama family and wish him every success as he takes

on this important assignment. Welcome to Agama FC, Coach Phiri. Together, we fight. Together, we rise,” the club said.

The Premier League debutants are lying 15th on the 18-team log.

From 26 matches played, The Sporting Eagles have won five, drawn seven, lost 14, scored 16 goals, conceded 34 and have 22 points.

The arrival of Phiri to the Mt. Darwin side brings to

three the number of Zambian gaffers playing their trade in Zimbabwe.

The other two are Kelvin Kaundu, a respected football figure in Zimbabwe with Hardrock while Ian Bakala is at Caps United.